# English Grammar Reference

Present Continuous Tense — Rules, Structures & Examples

## 1. WHEN TO USE THE PRESENT CONTINUOUS TENSE

### Actions Happening Now

Things happening at the exact moment of speaking.
***Example:*** I am reading a book right now.

### Temporary Situations

Actions happening around now, but not permanently.
***Example:*** She is studying in London this term.

### Future Plans

Fixed arrangements planned for the near future.
***Example:*** We are meeting tomorrow at 3 PM.

## 2. SENTENCE STRUCTURES

**General Formula:** Subject + **am / is / are** + **Verb-ing** (Present Participle)

### A. Positive Sentences (+)

| Subject | Verb "To Be" | Verb (-ing) & Example |
|---|---|---|
| **I** | **am** | I **am cooking** dinner right now. |
| **He / She / It** | **is** | He **is playing** tennis today. |
| **You / We / They** | **are** | They **are watching** a movie. |

### B. Negative Sentences (-)

| Subject | Be + Not | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **I** | **am not** | I **am not sleeping** at the moment. |
| **He / She / It** | **is not** (isn't) | She **isn't working** today. |
| **You / We / They** | **are not** (aren't) | We **aren't listening** to music. |

## 2. SENTENCE STRUCTURES (CONTINUED)

**C. Questions (?)**

| Verb "To Be" | Subject | Verb (-ing) & Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Am** | I | **Am** I **doing** this correctly? |
| **Is** | he / she / it | **Is** it **raining** outside? |
| **Are** | you / we / they | **Are** you **coming** to the party? |

## 3. SPELLING RULES FOR ADDING "-ING"

- **Most verbs:** Add `-ing` → *talk* → *talking* | *read* → *reading*
- **Verbs ending in Silent -E:** Drop the 'e' and add `-ing` → *make* → *making* | *write* → *writing*
- **Consonant-Vowel-Consonant (CVC):** Double the last letter and add `-ing` → *run* → *running* | *sit* → *sitting*
- **Verbs ending in -IE:** Change 'ie' to `-y + ing` → *die* → *dying* | *lie* → *lying*

## 4. STATIVE VERBS (DO NOT USE CONTINUOUS TENSE)

**Important Exception:** Stative verbs express states, feelings, or thoughts rather than actions. They are rarely used in the continuous form.

- **Emotions/Wants:** love, like, hate, want, need *(Say "I want coffee", NOT "I am wanting coffee")*
- **Mental States:** know, think, believe, understand, remember
- **Possession:** have, own, belong

## 5. COMMON TIME EXPRESSIONS

Look out for these signal words that often indicate the Present Continuous Tense:

- **Right now / Currently:** Now, right now, at the moment, currently
- **Temporary periods:** Today, this week, this semester, these days
- **Look! / Listen!:** *Look! It is snowing!* | *Listen! Someone is singing.*